

protected_areas_matching_key

Ia – Strict Nature Reserve

Definition: Areas strictly protected to preserve biodiversity and geological features; human visitation and use limited to scientific research, monitoring, and education.

- Examples:
 - Mount Nimba Strict Nature Reserve (Guinea/Côte d’Ivoire)
 - Aldabra Special Reserve (Seychelles)

Objective: Scientific research & monitoring only

II – National Park

Definition: Large natural or near-natural areas set aside to protect ecological processes, species and ecosystems; also provide for education, recreation and visitor opportunities.

- Examples:
 - Yellowstone National Park (USA)
 - Banff National Park (Canada)

Objective: Ecological process & recreation

III – Natural Monument or Feature

Definition: Areas set aside to protect a specific natural monument (landform, sea mount, geological or living feature); generally small with high visitor value.

- Examples:
 - Devils Tower National Monument (USA)
 - Rio São Francisco Natural Monument (Brazil)

Objective: Protect a specific feature / Feature protection & interpretation

IV – Habitat/Species Management Area

Definition: Areas managed primarily through active intervention (e.g., habitat restoration, invasive-species control, species monitoring) to protect particular species or habitats.

- Examples:
 - Don Edwards San Francisco Bay National Wildlife Refuge (USA)
 - CSKT Bison Range (USA)

Objective: Active habitat/species management

V – Protected Landscape/Seascape

Definition: Areas where people–nature interaction over time has created a landscape of distinct ecological, biological, cultural and scenic value, and where safeguarding that interaction is vital.

- Examples:
 - Lake District National Park (UK)
 - Tsugaru Quasi-National Park (Japan)

Objective: Maintain cultural–ecological interaction / Cultural–ecological stewardship

VI – Protected Area with Sustainable Use

Definition: Generally large areas, mostly in a natural condition, where a proportion is under sustainable natural-resource management and low-level non-industrial use compatible with conservation.

- Examples:
 - Ngorongoro Conservation Area (Tanzania)
 - Chico Mendes Extractive Reserve (Brazil)

Objective: Sustainable resource use